

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Audiophilia

The unnatural obsession with high quality sound marked by an excessive passion for high-end audio equipment. The afflicted want to experience sound reproduced with little or no loss. Read on to progress from audio-enthusiast to audiophilic.

SNR – Signal-to-noise ratio: It's the level of clean signal compared to noise coming out of your output source. Look for higher SNR and lower TDH

THD – Total Harmonic

Distortion: The amount of originally-recorded sound reaching your ears compared to distortion introduced by your components. Figures of 0.01% and lower are desirable for sound cards.

Impedance: Basically resistance. Changes as per frequency. Go for high impedance on low-end electronics.

Frequency response: It's a specification to measure how uniformly equipment reproduces sounds from the lowest to the highest tones. A uniform frequency response makes the delicate sound of a triangle as audible as the crash of a cymbal.

Reference speaker: Speakers or headphones that reproduce sound as it is, i.e. very close to the original recording. Like studio recording "reference monitors".

Soundstage: The presentation of the sound in relation to the listener.

Coloured: Simply to what extent, and where, the frequency is altered in reproduction.

Quality related terms: Warm, rich, full-bodied etc.

Brands: Sennheiser, Denon, AKG, Monitor Audio, Wilson Benesch.

Usage: These new AKG K-701 reference headphones I bought have an impedance of 62 ohms and man, what a broad soundstage! Really rich sound, absolutely uncoloured!

Wild Wild Web

Do you speak an English?

The Japanese are a funny lot, and the variation of English that they use is even funnier. They confuse the 'l' and 'r' sounds, leading to hilarious outcomes like Album Covers by Eric Crapton and campaign posters for Erections! Also much of the English on their signboards comes from literal translations from Japanese, with disastrously funny consequences – sign on a loo saying "Please use anyone". At www.english.com you'll find a

huge collection of such pics contributed by people all over the world. The web site takes a fun look at the various products, signs, bags, clothing, etc. that contain funny or far-out English. Guaranteed to keep you tickled for hours.

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tried to patent fire, and the wheel, the newest hunting grounds for opportunistic entrepreneurs is the web.

A Russian businessman has gone ahead and trademarked the oh brother emoticon. Oleg Teterin hopes to earn thousands of dollars in licensing fees. This means that no emoticon can be legally used in Russia because they all bear a similarity to the oh brother emoticon.

Being the benevolent individual that Teterin is, he has allowed lay users complete freedom to use the emoticon in the normal course of internet interaction. The trademark application has to be ratified by the Russian Patent Agency, and it remains to be seen if the trademark, in fact, be granted. Russian lawyers argue that the trademark may not be granted because of its wide use, and being against the interest of the general population.

This is not the first time that a smiley has been copyrighted. Way back in 2001, the :-(- emoticon was copyrighted by a US firm called Despair, Inc.

THE MARCH OF THE WARRIOR PENGUINS

Linux joins the OS advertising battle



The operating systems war have been waging for a long time now, and the two big players in the field have taken on distinct identities. Windows users are stereotyped as being stiff upper lip power tie wearing formal individuals, as against Mac addicts with the casual

clothes and the careless Seinfeld cut. Of course, Seinfeld switched loyalties in the recent \$300 million advertising campaign for Vista that was summarily dropped.

The 1337 tree-huggers of the computer world have something to celebrate. When not trying to install codecs into their Linux systems, they can spend their time making the I-am-Linux video. The Linux Foundation, a non-profit organisation hoping to spread the support for the open source operating system is planning to launch an advertising campaign made from these videos.

The brief for the video according to the official website is "in 60 seconds or less, showcase your take on I'm Linux. This should be why you love it and should inspire others to use it. The video can be an extensive production, a plain testimonial or as simple as a screen capture with a voice over. Be creative, be authentic and have fun." The winner will be decided by a panel of judges and